

ECO8000: Labor Economics

Fall 2026

Instructor Sam Gyetvay
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Course Description

This is a graduate course in labor economics. The goal is to introduce you to core theoretical models, quantitative methods, and applied empirical work in labor economics. A secondary goal is to discuss current research and to develop research ideas together.

There is no textbook. There are no formal prerequisites, but I will assume familiarity with calculus, linear algebra, econometrics, and basic microeconomic theory.

I will share slides, papers, problem sets, and other relevant materials on the course website. I will occasionally communicate with you via email. I do not use “moodle.”

Evaluation

Participation 20%

Attend class, answer questions, and contribute to discussion. Most weeks I will assign one paper to read, which we will discuss together in class. Be an informed participant in these discussions.

Presentation 30%

Present one recent unpublished labor economics working paper from a list I will provide.

Problem sets 20%

There will be two problem sets, containing a mix of theoretical and applied problems.

Final project 30%

A detailed proposal for an empirical research project. Will be developed throughout the semester under my guidance.

Course Calendar

Week	Date	Topic	Notes
1	Sep 14	Intro + metrics review	
2	Sep 21	Selection and the Roy model	
3	Sep 28	Human capital and education	
–	Oct 5	Provincial election	No class
–	Oct 12	Thanksgiving	No class
4	Oct 19	Labor supply and demand	Problem set 1 due
–	Oct 26	Reading week	No class
5	Nov 2	Search frictions and job loss	
6	Nov 9	Monopsony	
7	Nov 16	Firms	
8	Nov 23	Minimum wages	
9	Nov 30	Immigration	
10	Dec 7	Discrimination	Problem set 2 due
11	Dec 14	Student presentations	
12	Dec 21	Student presentations	

Papers

Week 2: Selection and the Roy model

Sep 21

Barry R. Chiswick (1978). “The Effect of Americanization on the Earnings of Foreign-Born Men”. *Journal of Political Economy* 86.5, pp. 897–921.

A. D. Roy (1951). “Some Thoughts on the Distribution of Earnings”. *Oxford Economic Papers* 3.2, pp. 135–146.

George J. Borjas (1985). “Assimilation, Changes in Cohort Quality, and the Earnings of Immigrants”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 3.4, pp. 463–489.

George J. Borjas (1987). “Self-Selection and the Earnings of Immigrants”. *American Economic Review* 77.4, pp. 531–553.

Casey B. Mulligan and Yona Rubinstein (2008). “Selection, Investment, and Women’s Relative Wages over Time”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 123.3, pp. 1061–1110.

† Ran Abramitzky, Leah Platt Boustan, and Katherine Eriksson (2012). “Europe’s Tired, Poor, Huddled Masses: Self-Selection and Economic Outcomes in the Age of Mass Migration”. *American Economic Review* 102.5, pp. 1832–1856.

Eric French and Christopher Taber (2011). “Identification of Models of the Labor Market”. *Handbook of Labor Economics*. Ed. by Orley Ashenfelter and David Card. Vol. 4A. Elsevier, pp. 537–617.

Week 3: Human capital and education

Sep 28

David Card (1999). “The Causal Effect of Education on Earnings”. *Handbook of Labor Economics*. Ed. by Orley C. Ashenfelter and David Card. Vol. 3. Elsevier, pp. 1801–1863.

Joshua D. Angrist and Alan B. Krueger (1991). “Does Compulsory School Attendance Affect Schooling and Earnings?” *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 106.4, pp. 979–1014.

Seth D. Zimmerman (2014). “The Returns to College Admission for Academically Marginal Students”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 32.4, pp. 711–754.

Stacy Berg Dale and Alan B. Krueger (2002). “Estimating the Payoff to Attending a More Selective College: An Application of Selection on Observables and Unobservables”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 117.4, pp. 1491–1527.

Stacy Berg Dale and Alan B. Krueger (2014). “Estimating the Effects of College Characteristics over the Career Using Administrative Earnings Data”. *Journal of Human Resources* 49.2, pp. 323–358.

Jack Mountjoy and Brent R. Hickman (2021). *The Returns to College(s): Relative Value-Added and Match Effects in Higher Education*. Working Paper.

Michael Spence (1973). “Job Market Signaling”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 87.3, pp. 355–374.

† Carolina Arteaga (2018). “The Effect of Human Capital on Earnings: Evidence from a Reform at Colombia’s Top University”. *Journal of Public Economics* 157, pp. 212–225.

Daron Acemoglu and David Autor (2011). “Skills, Tasks and Technologies: Implications for Employment and Earnings”. *Handbook of Labor Economics*. Ed. by Orley Ashenfelter and David Card. Vol. 4B. Elsevier, pp. 1043–1171.

Week 4: Labor supply and labor demand

Oct 19

Marie Connolly (2008). “Here Comes the Rain Again: Weather and the Intertemporal Substitution of Leisure”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 26.1, pp. 73–100.

Ernst Fehr and Lorenz Goette (2007). “Do Workers Work More if Wages Are High? Evidence from a Randomized Field Experiment”. *American Economic Review* 97.1, pp. 298–317.

† Daron Acemoglu, David H. Autor, and David Lyle (2004). “Women, War, and Wages: The Effect of Female Labor Supply on the Wage Structure at Midcentury”. *Journal of Political Economy* 112.3, pp. 497–551.

David Card and Thomas Lemieux (2001). “Can Falling Supply Explain the Rising Return to College for Younger Men? A Cohort-Based Analysis”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 116.2, pp. 705–746.

Daron Acemoglu and Pascual Restrepo (2019). “Automation and New Tasks: How Technology Displaces and Reinstates Labor”. *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 33.2, pp. 3–30.

Week 5: Search frictions and job loss

Nov 2

John J. McCall (1970). “Economics of Information and Job Search”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 84.1, pp. 113–126.

Kenneth Burdett and Dale T. Mortensen (1998). “Wage Differentials, Employer Size, and Unemployment”. *International Economic Review* 39.2, pp. 257–273.

Louis S. Jacobson, Robert J. LaLonde, and Daniel G. Sullivan (1993). “Earnings Losses of Displaced Workers”. *American Economic Review* 83.4, pp. 685–709.

Daniel Sullivan and Till von Wachter (2009). “Job Displacement and Mortality: An Analysis Using Administrative Data”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 124.3, pp. 1265–1306.

Steven J. Davis and Till von Wachter (2011). “Recessions and the Costs of Job Loss”. *Brookings Papers on Economic Activity* 2011.2, pp. 1–72.

Johannes F. Schmieder, Till von Wachter, and Jörg Heining (2023). “The Costs of Job Displacement over the Business Cycle and Its Sources: Evidence from Germany”. *American Economic Review* 113.5, pp. 1208–1254.

† Antoine Bertheau, Edoardo Maria Acabbi, Cristina Barceló, Andreas Gulyas, Stefano Lombardi, and Raffaele Saggio (2023). *The Unequal Consequences of Job Loss across Countries*.

Diogo G. C. Britto, Paolo Pinotti, and Breno Sampaio (2022). “The Effect of Job Loss and Unemployment Insurance on Crime in Brazil”. *Econometrica* 90.4, pp. 1393–1423.

Jonathan Roth, Pedro H. C. Sant’Anna, Alyssa Bilinski, and John Poe (2023). “What’s Trending in Difference-in-Differences? A Synthesis of the Recent Econometrics Literature”. *Journal of Econometrics* 235.2, pp. 2218–2244.

Week 6: Monopsony

Nov 9

Joan Robinson (1933). *The Economics of Imperfect Competition*. Macmillan.

Kenneth Burdett and Dale T. Mortensen (1998). “Wage Differentials, Employer Size, and Unemployment”. *International Economic Review* 39.2, pp. 257–273.

Alan Manning (2011). “Imperfect Competition in the Labor Market”. *Handbook of Labor Economics*. Ed. by Orley Ashenfelter and David Card. Vol. 4B. Elsevier, pp. 973–1041.

† Ernesto Dal Bó, Frederico Finan, and Martin A. Rossi (2013). “Strengthening State Capabilities: The Role of Financial Incentives in the Call to Public Service”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 128.3, pp. 1169–1218.

Week 7: Firms

Nov 16

Sumner H. Slichter (1950). “Notes on the Structure of Wages”. *Review of Economics and Statistics* 32.1, pp. 80–91.

Alan B. Krueger and Lawrence H. Summers (1988). “Efficiency Wages and the Inter-Industry Wage Structure”. *Econometrica* 56.2, pp. 259–293.

John M. Abowd, Francis Kramarz, and David N. Margolis (1999). “High Wage Workers and High Wage Firms”. *Econometrica* 67.2, pp. 251–333.

David Card, Ana Rute Cardoso, Joerg Heining, and Patrick Kline (2018). “Firms and Labor Market Inequality: Evidence and Some Theory”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 36.S1, S13–S70.

Patrick Kline, Raffaele Saggio, and Mikkel Sølvsten (2020). “Leave-Out Estimation of Variance Components”. *Econometrica* 88.5, pp. 1859–1898.

Robert Gibbons, Lawrence F. Katz, Thomas Lemieux, and Daniel Parent (2005). “Comparative Advantage, Learning, and Sectoral Wage Determination”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 23.4, pp. 681–724.

Fabien Postel-Vinay and Jean-Marc Robin (2002). “Equilibrium Wage Dispersion with Worker and Employer Heterogeneity”. *Econometrica* 70.6, pp. 2295–2350.

David Card, Jörg Heining, and Patrick Kline (2013). “Workplace Heterogeneity and the Rise of West German Wage Inequality”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 128.3, pp. 967–1015.

David Card, Ana Rute Cardoso, and Patrick Kline (2016). “Bargaining, Sorting, and the Gender Wage Gap: Quantifying the Impact of Firms on the Relative Pay of Women”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 131.2, pp. 633–686.

François Gerard, Lorenzo Lagos, Edson Severnini, and David Card (2021). “Assortative Matching or Exclusionary Hiring? The Impact of Employment and Pay Policies on Racial Wage Differences in Brazil”. *American Economic Review* 111.10, pp. 3418–3457.

Benoit Dostie, Jiang Li, David Card, and Daniel Parent (2023). “Employer Policies and the Immigrant-Native Earnings Gap”. *Journal of Econometrics* 233.2, pp. 544–567.

Sabrina Di Addario, Patrick Kline, Raffaele Saggio, and Mikkel Sølvsten (2023). “It Ain’t Where You’re from, It’s Where You’re at: Hiring Origins, Firm Heterogeneity, and Wages”. *Journal of Econometrics* 233.2, pp. 340–374.

Marta Lachowska, Alexandre Mas, Raffaele Saggio, and Stephen A. Woodbury (2023). “Do Firm Effects Drift? Evidence from Washington Administrative Data”. *Journal of Econometrics* 233.2, pp. 375–395.

Isaac Sorkin (2018). “Ranking Firms Using Revealed Preference”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 133.3, pp. 1331–1393.

David Card, Jesse Rothstein, and Moises Yi (2024). “Industry Wage Differentials: A Firm-Based Approach”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 42.S1, S11–S59.

Jae Song, David J. Price, Fatih Guvenen, Nicholas Bloom, and Till von Wachter (2019). “Firming Up

Inequality”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 134.1, pp. 1–50.

Week 8: Minimum wages

Nov 23

David Card and Alan B. Krueger (1994). “Minimum Wages and Employment: A Case Study of the Fast-Food Industry in New Jersey and Pennsylvania”. *The American Economic Review* 84.4, pp. 772–793.

Laura Giuliano (2013). “Minimum Wage Effects on Employment, Substitution, and the Teenage Labor Supply: Evidence from Personnel Data”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 31.1, pp. 155–194.

Peter Harasztosi and Attila Lindner (2019). “Who Pays for the Minimum Wage?” *American Economic Review* 109.8, pp. 2693–2727.

Doruk Cengiz, Arindrajit Dube, Attila Lindner, and Ben Zipperer (2019). “The Effect of Minimum Wages on Low-Wage Jobs”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 134.3, pp. 1405–1454.

Christian Dustmann, Attila Lindner, Uta Schönberg, Matthias Umkehrer, and Philipp vom Berge (2022). “Reallocation Effects of the Minimum Wage”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 137.1, pp. 267–328.

Arindrajit Dube and Attila Lindner (2024). “Minimum Wages in the 21st Century”. *Handbook of Labor Economics*. Vol. 5. Elsevier, pp. 261–383.

Doruk Cengiz, Arindrajit Dube, Attila Lindner, and David Zentler-Munro (2022). “Seeing beyond the Trees: Using Machine Learning to Estimate the Impact of Minimum Wages on Labor Market Outcomes”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 40.S1, S203–S247.

Week 9: Immigration

Nov 30

George J. Borjas (2003). “The Labor Demand Curve Is Downward Sloping: Reexamining the Impact of Immigration on the Labor Market”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 118.4, pp. 1335–1374.

Gianmarco I. P. Ottaviano and Giovanni Peri (2012). “Rethinking the Effect of Immigration on Wages”. *Journal of the European Economic Association* 10.1, pp. 152–197.

David Card (1990). “The Impact of the Mariel Boatlift on the Miami Labor Market”. *Industrial and Labor Relations Review* 43.2, pp. 245–257.

Giovanni Peri and Vasil Yassenov (2017). “The Labor Market Effects of a Refugee Wave: Synthetic Control Method Meets the Mariel Boatlift”. *Journal of Human Resources* 54.2, pp. 267–309.

Jennifer Hunt (1992). “The Impact of the 1962 Repatriates from Algeria on the French Labor Market”. *Industrial and Labor Relations Review* 45.3, pp. 556–572.

Rachel M. Friedberg (2001). “The Impact of Mass Migration on the Israeli Labor Market”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 116.4, pp. 1373–1408.

Joshua D. Angrist and Adriana D. Kugler (2003). “Protective or Counter-Productive? Labour Market Institutions and the Effect of Immigration on EU Natives”. *Economic Journal* 113.488, F302–F331.

David Card (2001). “Immigrant Inflows, Native Outflows, and the Local Labor Market Impacts of Higher Immigration”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 19.1, pp. 22–64.

Kirill Borusyak, Peter Hull, and Xavier Jaravel (2025). “A Practical Guide to Shift-Share Instruments”. *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 39.1, pp. 181–204.

Paul Goldsmith-Pinkham, Isaac Sorkin, and Henry Swift (2020). “Bartik Instruments: What, When, Why, and How”. *American Economic Review* 110.8, pp. 2586–2624.

Christian Dustmann, Uta Schönberg, and Jan Stuhler (2017). “Labor Supply Shocks, Native Wages, and the Adjustment of Local Employment”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 132.1, pp. 435–483.

Andreas Beerli, Jan Ruffner, Michael Siegenthaler, and Giovanni Peri (2021). “The Abolition of Immigration Restrictions and the Performance of Firms and Workers: Evidence from Switzerland”. *American Economic Review* 111.3, pp. 976–1012.

Parag Mahajan, Nicolas Morales, Kevin Y. Shih, Mingyu Chen, and Agostina Brinatti (2025). *The Impact of Immigration on Firms and Workers: Insights from the H-1B Lottery*.

Week 10: Discrimination

Dec 7

Kenneth J. Arrow (1973). “The Theory of Discrimination”. *Discrimination in Labor Markets*. Princeton University Press.

Joseph G. Altonji and Rebecca M. Blank (1999). “Race and Gender in the Labor Market”. *Handbook of Labor Economics*. Vol. 3. Elsevier, pp. 3143–3259.

Gary S. Becker (1957). *The Economics of Discrimination*. University of Chicago Press.

Dennis J. Aigner and Glen G. Cain (1977). “Statistical Theories of Discrimination in Labor Markets”. *Industrial and Labor Relations Review* 30.2, pp. 175–187.

Raj Chetty, Nathaniel Hendren, Maggie R Jones, and Sonya R Porter (2020). “Race and Economic Opportunity in the United States: An Intergenerational Perspective”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 135.2, pp. 711–783.

David Card, Ana Rute Cardoso, and Patrick Kline (2016). “Bargaining, Sorting, and the Gender Wage Gap: Quantifying the Impact of Firms on the Relative Pay of Women”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 131.2, pp. 633–686.

Nina Roussille (2024). *The Central Role of the Ask Gap in Gender Pay Inequality*.

Claudia Goldin (2014). “A Grand Gender Convergence: Its Last Chapter”. *American Economic Review* 104.4, pp. 1091–1119.

Valentin Bolotnyy and Natalia Emanuel (2022). “Why Do Women Earn Less Than Men? Evidence from Bus and Train Operators”. *Journal of Labor Economics* 40.2, pp. 283–323.

Marianne Bertrand and Sendhil Mullainathan (2004). “Are Emily and Greg More Employable Than Lakisha and Jamal? A Field Experiment on Labor Market Discrimination”. *American Economic Review* 94.4, pp. 991–1013.

Jonathan Guryan and Kerwin Kofi Charles (2013). “Taste-Based or Statistical Discrimination: The Economics of Discrimination Returns to Its Roots”. *The Economic Journal* 123.572, F417–F432.

Patrick Kline, Evan K Rose, and Christopher R Walters (2022). “Systemic Discrimination Among Large U.S. Employers”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 137.4, pp. 1963–2036.

Patrick Kline, Evan K. Rose, and Christopher R. Walters (2024). “A Discrimination Report Card”. *American Economic Review* 114.8, pp. 2472–2525.

Evan K Rose (2021). “Who Gets a Second Chance? Effectiveness and Equity in Supervision of Criminal Offenders”. *The Quarterly Journal of Economics* 136.2, pp. 1199–1253.

Isaac Sorkin (2025). *Quantifying Racial Disparities Using Consecutive Employment Spells*.

David Card, Alexandre Mas, and Jesse Rothstein (2008). “Tipping and the Dynamics of Segregation”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 123.1, pp. 177–218.

J. Aislinn Bohren, Peter Hull, and Alex Imas (2025). “Systemic Discrimination: Theory and Measurement”. *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 140.3, pp. 1743–1799.

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